ENG 1011, Class 6

Listening Strategies and Practice



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THE COMPLETE LISTENING PROCESS

From Reception to Action in Communication

[INPUT PHASE]



1. RECEIVING (Hearing the Message)

- Physically hear the message and take note of incoming auditory input.
- affected by various external factors, such as noise, poor hearing, lack of attention etc.



2. INTERPRETING (Decoding Meaning)

- Infer the speaker's meaning, based on your own experiences, expectations, values, beliefs, ideas, and needs.
- Need to consider whether the speaker's frame of reference is similar or different to yours and how this will affect youerstanding of his/her meaning

[PROCESSING PHASE]



3. REMEMBERING (Storing Information)

- Store the message for future reference.
- Perhaps take notes or make a mental note of the key points as they are mentioned



4. EVALUATING (Critical Analysis)

- Consider the points mentioned and assess their importance.
- Separate fact from opinion and assess the quality of the facts provided by the speaker

[OUTPUT & EXECUTION PHASE]



5. RESPONDING (Providing Feedback)

- One-to-one or group situation: Verbal, or non-verbal expression.
- Large audience: May laugh or applaud, or make some notes, and may not act on what you have heard until much later



6. ACTING (Follow-Through)

- Put all promised action in writing so as to avoid any misunderstandings.
- Make sure to deliver your promises always

1. Read the instructions carefully

Check:

- How many words are allowed?
- Do you need a word or a number?

2. Read the questions quickly

Understand what information you need.

Example:

Question: Where does the man live?
Think: → I need a **place name**

Question: "_____ is the manager of the company."
Prediction: → **Person's name**

3. Underline keywords

Underline important words that help you find the answer.

Example:

Question: What time does the train leave from London?

Keywords:

- time
- train
- leave
- London

4. Predict the topic and situation

Think:

- Who is speaking?
- Where are they?

Example: Hotel Reservation

Prediction: You may hear:

- guest name
- booking date
- room type
- price

5. Be careful of traps

Speakers often change information.

Example:

Speaker: *"The meeting was planned for **5 pm**... but actually it will be at **7 pm**."*

6. Watch for paraphrasing

The question and audio may use different words.

Example:

Question: **"Why did he leave the job?"**

Audio: *"He **resigned** because of **health problems**."*

7. Do not try to understand everything

Your goal is not to understand the whole conversation.

Your goal: ✅ **Find answers only.**

Example:

Audio talks about:

- weather
- history
- price
- location

If the question asks **price**, ignore other information.

ADVANCED STRATEGIES FOR IMPROVING LISTENING SKILLS

SECTION 1: BEYOND THE WORDS & KEY HABITS

KEY HABITS

1. 
Being Mindful

2. 
Staying Patient

CORE LISTENING BEHAVIORS

3. 
3. Listening Between the Words

4. 
4. Paying Attention to Non-Verbal Cues

5. 

Making Eye Contact and Sound of Appreciation

6. 
6. Using Silence

SECTION 2: LINGUISTIC CUES & CONNECTED SPEECH

SIGNPOSTING & DISCOURSE MARKERS

ADDING DETAIL	CONTRADICTION / CHANGE	CAUSE / EFFECT
+	VS	→
Furthermore... In addition...	However... On the other hand... Actually...	As a result... Therefore...

WHY IT MATTERS: Speakers use these transitional words to signal structure, contrast, or conclusions.

PAY ATTENTION TO INTONATION & CONNECTED SPEECH

INTONATION
THE RISE AND FALL OF THE VOICE



RISING
Questions, lists
- Would you like a cup of tea?
- Shopping list





FALLING
Statements, Commands, Exclamations, End of sentence
- What a beautiful day!
- Commands

CONNECTED SPEECH FEATURES

LINKING
Check it out → Cheki tout

STRESS
content words nouns/verbs VS **structure words** structure words

WHY IT MATTERS: Natural fast-speech features like linking, elision, and assimilation can obscure known words.

Listening Practice: Sentence Completion



Instructions: Listen to the announcement and fill in the missing words for each sentence using NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS AND/OR A NUMBER.

1. The current head of department, James Watson, will leave his position at the end of _____.
2. The staff car park will be closed for a few weeks next month due to upcoming _____.
3. Staff members who arrive after 8:30 a.m. must park their vehicles in the _____.
4. Anyone using the temporary church car park must make sure to leave before _____.
5. Payment in the canteen can now be made using either a smartphone or a(n) _____.

Listening Practice: Answers of Sentence Completion



1. The current head of department, James Watson, will leave his position at the end of **this week**.

2. The staff car park will be closed for a few weeks next month due to upcoming **improvements**.

3. Staff members who arrive after 8:30 a.m. must park their vehicles in the **church car park**.

4. Anyone using the temporary church car park must make sure to leave before **6 p.m.**

5. Payment in the canteen can now be made using either a smartphone or a(n) **company ID card**.

Two people talking about changing their plans



➢ Listening Practice: MCQ - **Instructions**: choose the correct answer (A, B, C, or D) for each question.

1. Why did Sachi not have the theatre tickets yet?
   A) She forgot to buy them.
   B) She was planning to buy them this afternoon.
   C) They were sold out.
   D) Francesco told her not to buy them earlier.

2. Why can't Francesco go to the play this Friday?
   A)He has band practice.
   B) He has to attend his nephew's birthday party.
   C) He has a concert to perform at.
   D) He wants to go to the cinema instead.

3. What reason did Francesco give for making alternative plans previously?
   A)Going to a dance show.
   B) Seeing the new Marvel movie.
   C) Playing at his nephew's birthday party.
   D) Attending a family dinner.

4. What does Francesco suggest doing before his concert this Friday?
   A) Going out for dinner
   B) Buying tickets for next week
   C) Going to the cinema
   D) Watching a dance group

5. How does Sachi react to Francesco's new proposal?
   A) She refuses to meet him at all.
   B) She agrees, provided he promises to go to the play next Friday.
   C) She offers to buy cinema tickets instead.
   D) She cancels all future plans with him.

➢ Listening Practice: Answers of MCQ

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